

Company/App Name: Amazon Shopping app

Understand the Business First

What does the company do, and who pays for it?

Amazon is a multinational technology company engaged in e-commerce, cloud computing, digital advertising, and streaming. For the shopping app specifically, customers pay for the products they buy, while third-party sellers pay fees, commissions, and fulfillment costs to list and sell on the platform. Amazon Prime members also pay a subscription fee.

How does it make money?

Amazon makes money through several key revenue streams:

1. **Online Stores:** Direct retail sales.
2. **Third-Party Seller Services:** Commissions, fulfillment (FBA), and other seller fees.
3. **Amazon Web Services (AWS):** Cloud computing services—a major profit driver.
4. **Advertising:** Sponsored product listings and brand ads.
5. **Subscriptions:** Prime membership fees

What are the main things it has to get right to run well?

To run well, Amazon must excel at:

- **Logistics & Fulfillment:** Fast, reliable delivery and efficient inventory management.
- **Customer Experience:** A seamless, intuitive app interface and easy checkout.
- **Pricing & Selection:** Competitive prices and a vast product catalog.
- **Technology & Infrastructure:** Robust servers to handle traffic and AI for recommendations.
- **Innovation:** Strong **Research and Development** department which should constantly predict consumers demands and build new features to address same.

Where do things go wrong, or get slow, expensive, or frustrating?

Common pain points include:

- **Delivery & Returns:** Wrong or delayed deliveries, lost items, and fraudulent returns (e.g., customers returning different or damaged products)
- **Customer Support:** Poor communication, unhelpful AI chatbots, difficulty reaching a human agent
- **App Performance:** Slowness, lag, and freezing, especially during high-traffic periods

- **Insufficient Inventory Stock** – Frequent out of stock of items makes customer frustrating and may switch to competitors.

What information or data does the business collect along the way?

Amazon collects extensive data, including:

- **Location Data:** Timestamped geolocation data, allegedly collected without explicit consent through its Ads SDK embedded in third-party apps.
- **Browsing & Purchase History:** Products viewed, searched, and bought.
- **Device Information:** Phone model, operating system, and app usage patterns.
- **Personal Information:** Name, address, payment details, and communication preferences.

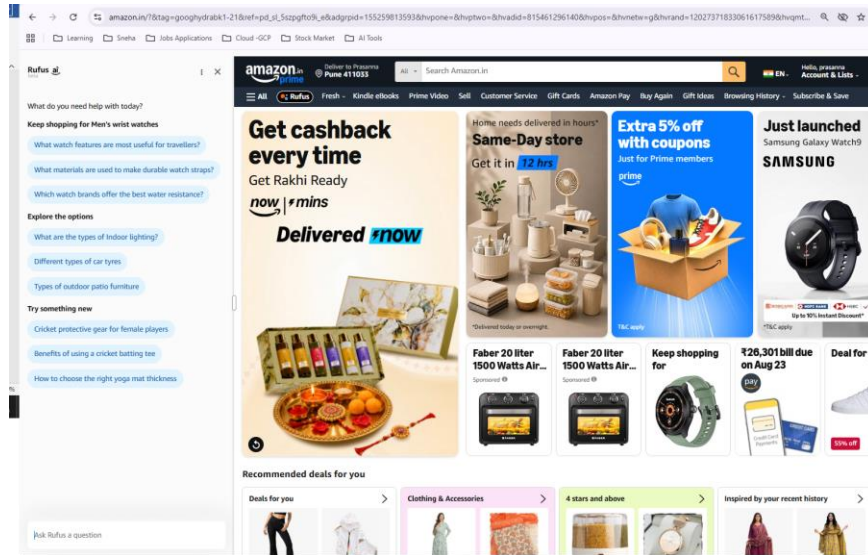
Suggest AI Features

Feature	Problem it solves	Type of AI	Data needed	What it improves	Metrics it will impact
Try-on Air (3D virtual placement)	Apparel/furniture returns average 24-30% due to visual/size mismatch, driving high reverse logistics costs.	Image AI (CV) + AR	3D/2D catalog assets of items.	Purchase confidence & retention	Return Rate (%), Net Return Cost, CSAT
Size & Compatibility Predictor	Wearable items returned due to size mismatch; requires customers to manually compare size charts.	Prediction AI (ML)	Seller size charts, historical return data, and customer reviews.	Order accuracy & trust	Return Rate (wearables), CSAT
Rufus AI (Add Voice + Image inputs to Web)	Currently, the Web Rufus is text-only (per current UI). Users must type complex queries, and cannot search via photo, creating friction for desktop shoppers.	Voice AI + Image AI	Product embeddings, catalog images, and pre-trained STT models.	Search discovery & ease	Time-to-Purchase (mins), Search Success Rate, Net Sales via Rufus
AI Review Summaries	Customers read 50+ reviews to decide—overwhelming and slow	Text Analysis AI (NLP/Sentiment) + Generative AI	Product reviews (millions of them).	Decision speed & trust	Time-to-purchase, CSAT, Return rate
AI Shopping Guide	Customers don't know what to look for which addresses their ask (Ex. Which color curtain looks good on my wall OR to make cake what all items are required)	Generative AI (LLM) + Text Analysis	Product catalog, expert content, community Q&As, reviews	Product education & discovery	Search success rate, CSAT

Which feature you would build first and why.

Feature Name - Rufus AI (Add Voice + Image inputs to the Web version)

Current Feature Image – lacks voice and image inputs acceptance in Rufus AI chatbot window.



Why

This is the lowest-effort, highest-impact move. Voice transcription and visual search are already live on mobile—we're just exposing those existing APIs to the desktop UI. No new models, no heavy data pipelines.

Meanwhile, the current Web version is text-only, which creates a clear parity gap for desktop users. Closing that unlocks an immediate conversion lift—mobile Rufus users are already ~60% more likely to purchase, so extending that to Web pays off across every category.

Compare this to the other four:

- **Try-on** needs 3D asset generation per SKU—months of pipeline work.
- **Size Predictor** requires new user-photo data, raising privacy hurdles and adoption risk.
- **Review Summaries** demands processing millions of reviews per product (high compute/latency) plus generative summarization with hallucination risk. But this could be my second choice of implementation.
- **Shopping Guides** needs heavy prompt engineering and content curation to avoid bad recommendations.

Rufus Web is a few weeks of frontend + API work, impacts every category, and gives us a quick A/B test win—measuring time-to-purchase and search success directly against the current text-only baseline. No other feature delivers this much impact with this little risk.